

Developer Associate Certification - Thoughts

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Assisted on Slides 2-4

Comparison with SAA-C03

DVA-C02 goes deeper into:

- Serverless development
- Service integration
- Deployment automation
- Observability & optimization

Assumes you already know: IAM, VPC, S3, RDS, HA

Shift the angle: less architecture, more code + integration patterns





Comparison in short

Dimension	SAA-C03	DVA-C02
Focus	Architecture, design, resilience	Development, integration, deployment
Typical questions	High availability, networking, storage, security	Lambda patterns, API Gateway, DynamoDB, CI/CD
Technical level	Broad, generalist	Deep in serverless & runtime
Skills required	Infrastructure + cloud design	Code, events, SDKs, IaC
Key services	EC2, ALB/NLB, RDS, VPC	Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, SQS/SNS, EventBridge
Mindset	How to design it	How to build, integrate and operate it

Conclusion:
→ SAA = *how to design the system*
→ DVA = *how to build and integrate the system*

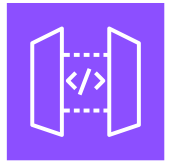
Services you must master



AWS Lambda

3 page of services, really ?:

- AWS Lambda
- API Gateway (REST + HTTP + WebSocket)
- DynamoDB (partition key, sort key, GSIs, LSI, streams)
- SQS / SNS
- EventBridge
- CloudWatch / X-Ray
- IaC tools: SAM / CloudFormation



Amazon API Gateway



Amazon DynamoDB



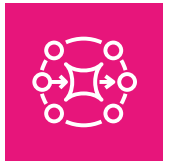




Amazon Simple Notification Service (Amazon SNS)



Amazon Simple Queue Service (Amazon SQS)



Amazon MQ

DVA-C02 Exam Guide

The exam also validates a candidate's ability to complete the following tasks:

- Develop and optimize applications on AWS.
- Package and deploy by using continuous integration and continuous delivery (CI/CD) workflows.
- Secure application code and data.
- Identify and resolve application issues.

Target candidate description

The target candidate should have 1 or more years of hands-on experience in developing and maintaining applications by using AWS services.

Recommended AWS knowledge

The target candidate should be able to complete the following tasks:

- Develop and secure applications by using AWS service APIs, the AWS Command Line Interface (AWS CLI), and SDKs.
- Use a CI/CD pipeline to deploy applications on AWS.



Review Description

Developing on AWS - Course

Course objectives

In this course, you will learn to:

- Set up the AWS SDK and developer credentials for Java, C#/.NET, and Python
- Interact with AWS services and develop solutions by using the AWS SDK
- Use AWS Identity and Access Management (IAM) for service authentication
- Use Amazon Simple Storage Service (Amazon S3) and Amazon DynamoDB as data stores
- Integrate applications and data by using AWS Lambda, Amazon API Gateway, SQS, SNS, and AWS Step Functions
- Use Amazon Cognito for user authentication
- Use Amazon ElastiCache to improve application scalability
- Leverage the CI/CD pipeline to deploy applications on AWS



Developing on AWS - Outline

Day 1

Module 0: Course Overview

Module 1: Introduction to AWS: Infrastructure overview, Introduction to AWS foundation services

Module 2: Introduction to Developing on AWS: Introduction to developer tools, management tools

Module 3: Introduction to AWS Identity and Access Management: IAM, AuthN&AuthZ

Module 4: Introduction to the Lab Environment

Module 5: Developing Storage Solutions with S3: Troubleshooting



Day 2

Module 6: Developing Flexible NoSQL Solutions with Amazon DynamoDB: Best practices, Troubleshooting

Module 7: Developing Event-Driven Solutions with AWS Lambda: How Lambda works, Use cases, Best practices

Module 8: Developing Solutions with Amazon API Gateway: Developing with API Gateway, Best practices, Introduction to SAM

Module 9: Developing Solutions with AWS Step Functions: Use cases

Day 3

Module 10: Developing Solutions with SQS and SNS: Developing SQS, SNS; Developing with Amazon MQ

Module 11: Caching Information with Amazon ElastiCache: Caching strategies

Module 12: Developing Secure Applications

Module 13: Deploying Applications: Devops, Deployment and testing strategies, AWS Elastic Beanstalk

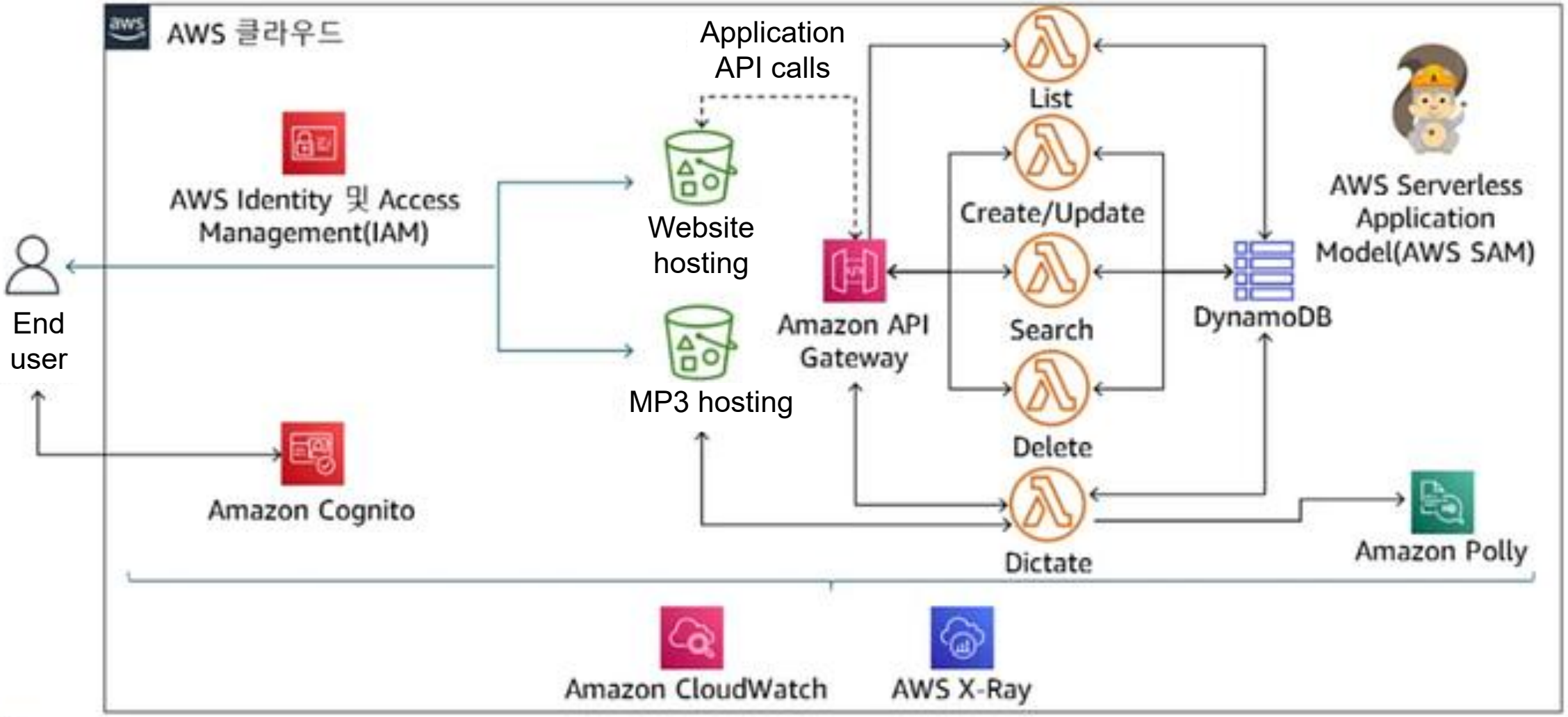
Module 14: Course wrap-up

Frequent Patterns

- API Gateway → Lambda → DynamoDB
- Event-driven architectures: SQS, SNS, EventBridge
- Retries, Dead Letter Queues (DLQs)
- Deployment strategies: Lambda versions & aliases, blue/green
- Observability: Logs, metrics, tracing
- Serverless best practices (for DVA-C02)



Proposed Lab



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Link

Types of questions & how to answer them

Focus on:

- Managed services vs self-managed
- Serverless vs servers
- Scalability & HA
- Limits, tuning, troubleshooting, error handler

Approach:

- Think in terms of best practice within AWS ecosystem
- Confusing IAM roles vs policies
- Overlooking idempotency in functions
- Ignoring DLQ / retry logic
- Poor design in DynamoDB: hot partitions, inefficient queries

Study Plan

W1: Dive into Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB — hands-on labs
W2: Infrastructure as Code, CI/CD, SAM
W3: Practice with mock exams, identify weaknesses
W4: Final review, simulated exam conditions

Which API SDK have to use

SDK types

- Low-level API
- High-level API

Example of a low-level API: **Get a list of S3 buckets.**

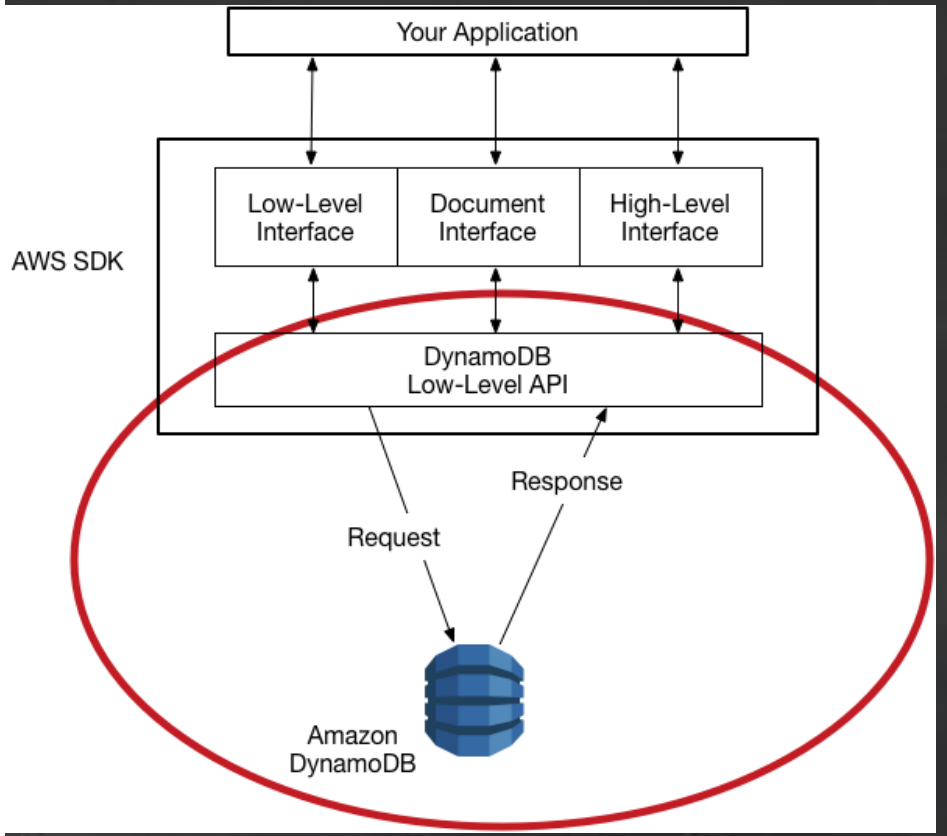
```
# Retrieve the list of existing buckets
s3 = boto3.client('s3')
response = s3.list_buckets_v2(Bucket='mybucket')

for content in response['Contents']:
    print(f'  {content["Key"]} : {content["LastModified"]}')
```

Example of a high-level API: Retrieving a list of S3 buckets (same functionality as above). It can be used more concisely through abstraction, and can be accessed and used like a Method/Member rather than accessing it directly as a structure (JSON).

```
# Retrieve the list of existing buckets
s3 = boto3.resource('s3')
bucket = s3.Bucket('mybucket')

for obj in bucket.objects.all():
    print(f'  {obj.key} : {obj.last_modified')
```



clipse Powershell

Resources

AWS Developer Associate – Official Page
https://aws.amazon.com/certification/certified-developer-associate/

Exam Guide (DVA-C02 PDF)
https://d1.awsstatic.com/training-and-certification/docs-dev-associate/AWS-Certified-Developer-Associate_Exam-Guide.pdf

AWS Digital Training (Skill Builder)
https://skillbuilder.aws/

AWS Documentation Homepage
https://docs.aws.amazon.com/

AWS SaaS / Serverless Patterns Collection
https://serverlessland.com/patterns

Tutorial Dojo
https://tutorialsdojo.com/aws-certified-developer-associate-exam-guide-study-path-dva-c02/

Jayendra's Cloud Certification Blog

https://jayendrapatil.com/aws-certified-developer-associate-dva-c02-exam-learning-path/

Resources - Workshop

AWS Lambda (14) Workshops

DynamoDB (5) Workshops

API Gateway (8) Workshops

AWS SAM (2) Workshops

AWS CodePipeline (3) Workshops

CI-CD (1) Workshop

Skill Builder

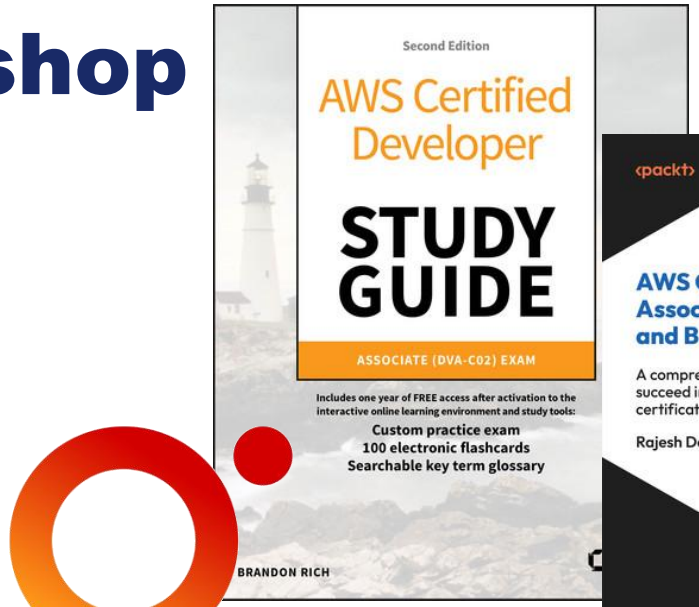
AWS Certified Developer - Associate (DVA-C03 - English)

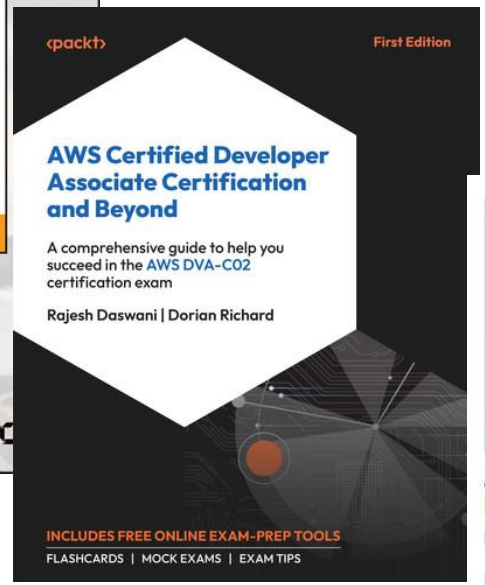
O'Reilly Books

Links on the covers

Udemy Courses

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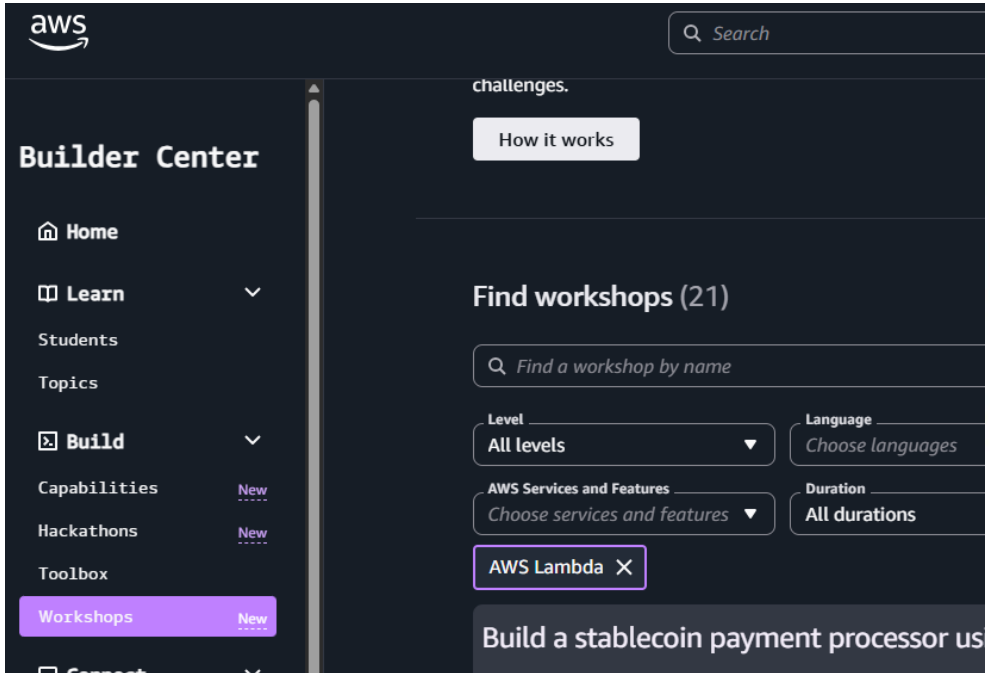




AWS Certified Developer Associate - EXAM REVIEW - 2021

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START COURSE





AWS Certified Developer Associate Exam - Practice Tests 2021

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